

FORMAT: IMAGE

"BREAKING: Large explosion near the Pentagon Complex in Washington, D.C." — a photo shows a plume of black smoke beside a large government building.

Shared Monday morning by several accounts, including ones impersonating a major news wire. Briefly moved the U.S. stock market before officials denied any incident.

SOURCE	EVIDENCE	EMOTION	INTENT	TRACE
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Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

— FOLD OR CUT HERE BEFORE HANDING TO TEAMS · FACILITATOR ANSWER BELOW —

CONFIRMED: AI-GENERATED

No independent witnesses ever surfaced despite the location being one of the busiest in the country, and open-source investigators quickly spotted the building's fence line merging strangely into a crowd barrier — a classic sign of AI-generated architecture. Officials confirmed within the hour that nothing had happened.

Source: NPR · The Washington Post · Al Jazeera, May 2023

A photograph from a 1969 Moon landing shows an astronaut planting a flag — the fabric appears to ripple, as if caught in a breeze.

Widely shared for decades with the caption: "There's no wind on the Moon. Explain that."

SOURCE

EVIDENCE

EMOTION

INTENT

TRACE

Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

— FOLD OR CUT HERE BEFORE HANDING TO TEAMS · FACILITATOR ANSWER BELOW —

CONFIRMED: GENUINE

The flag was fitted with a horizontal rod specifically because there's no atmosphere to hold fabric flat — the "ripple" is the rod and the astronaut's hands still moving it into place, not wind. The landing sites have since been independently confirmed by laser retroreflectors still in use today and by high-resolution orbiter photos of the equipment left behind.

Source: NASA mission archives · independent lunar orbiter imagery

FORMAT: VOICE CALL

"It's important that you save your vote for the November election." A robocall reaches thousands of voters two days before a primary, in a voice that sounds exactly like a sitting president.

The call urged recipients to skip the upcoming primary and used one of the president's well-known catchphrases earlier in the message.

SOURCE	EVIDENCE	EMOTION	INTENT	TRACE
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Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

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CONFIRMED: AI-GENERATED

Digital forensics experts flagged an unnatural, clipped cadence toward the end of the recording — a common tell in cloned voices. The call was traced to a political consultant, who was later criminally charged and fined by federal regulators for voter suppression.

Source: NBC News · PBS NewsHour · NPR, January 2024

FORMAT: HOT MIC

During a live summit, a sitting U.S. president is caught on an open microphone telling a foreign leader he'll have "more flexibility" after his re-election campaign — not realizing the feed was still recording.

Picked up by the official press pool microphone and broadcast live before anyone could cut the audio.

SOURCE	EVIDENCE	EMOTION	INTENT	TRACE
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Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

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CONFIRMED: GENUINE

This was captured by the White House press pool's own equipment and confirmed on video by multiple wire services in the room at the time — an open mic, not a clone. A real hot-mic moment usually has grainy, ambient sound and visible video of the two people actually speaking, unlike a fabricated clip built around a static photo.

Source: 2012 press pool recordings, multiple outlets

FORMAT: AUDIO CLIP

Two days before a national election, an audio clip surfaces appearing to capture a leading opposition politician calmly discussing with a journalist how to rig the vote.

Released during a legal pre-election media blackout, when journalists were barred from reporting on new election-related claims — so the clip spread for two days before it was formally debunked.

SOURCE	EVIDENCE	EMOTION	INTENT	TRACE
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Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

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CONFIRMED: AI-GENERATED

Fact-checkers flagged poor audio quality and unnatural speech patterns within hours, and both people named in the recording denied it ever happened. The timing — dropped right as reporting was legally restricted — was the real weapon: Trace and Intent would have caught this even without any technical analysis.

Source: AFP · CNN · Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review, September 2023

FORMAT: SATELLITE HEADLINE

"Satellite images show roughly a third of the country underwater at once." A headline about catastrophic monsoon flooding spreads alongside aerial photos that look almost too extreme to be real.

Some readers assumed the images had to be exaggerated or digitally altered given the scale being claimed.

SOURCE

EVIDENCE

EMOTION

INTENT

TRACE

Team vote: Genuine or AI-generated

— FOLD OR CUT HERE BEFORE HANDING TO TEAMS · FACILITATOR ANSWER BELOW —

CONFIRMED: GENUINE

This describes Pakistan's 2022 floods, independently confirmed by multiple international space agencies and humanitarian organisations using satellite data, not a single viral account. The scale felt unbelievable — which is exactly why it's worth checking Evidence before assuming "too extreme" means "fake."

Source: international satellite monitoring agencies and humanitarian reporting, 2022

FORMAT: VIDEO, LABELLED

A jailed former prime minister's party posts a video of him giving a victory speech after election results come in. His face is from an older, real clip — but the voice, and everything it says, is new.

The party captioned the post "AI version" before sharing it to millions of followers.

SOURCE

EVIDENCE

EMOTION

INTENT

TRACE

Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

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CONFIRMED: AI-GENERATED (AND DISCLOSED)

This one is AI-generated and openly labelled as such by the people who made it — that's the twist. A visible label from the original poster doesn't erase the need for SEE-IT: the caption often disappears the moment a clip is re-shared or screen-recorded onto another account without it. Intent still matters even when nothing is hidden.

Source: Voicebot.ai · Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists, February 2024

FORMAT: PHONE CALL

A mother answers a call from an unknown number and hears her teenage daughter's voice, sobbing: "Mom, I messed up." A man takes over the call demanding a ransom.

The daughter was actually away on a ski trip the entire time, safe, with no idea any of this was happening.

SOURCE	EVIDENCE	EMOTION	INTENT	TRACE
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Team vote:Genuine or AI-generated

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CONFIRMED: AI-GENERATED

The voice was cloned from only a few seconds of the daughter's real audio — likely pulled from something as ordinary as a public social media video. The mother later testified to lawmakers that it was "completely her voice," inflection and all. Family members were confirmed safe within four minutes, once someone else in the room called to check.

Source: CNN · ABC News · U.S. Senate Special Committee on Aging testimony, 2023